



## FOOD FOR THOUGHT

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# SWEET RECOVERY

The author suggests some **high-protein** desserts that can satisfy the sweet cravings of athletes without interfering with their recovery.

**A**s a nutritionist working closely with athletes, I fully understand the sacrifice and dedication required to push your body to its limits during training. Recovery is just as critical as the workout itself, and the right nutrition plays a crucial role in ensuring you get the most out of your efforts. But let's be honest, sometimes you just need a treat to keep you motivated and on track. That's why I want to share with you some high-protein dessert options that can satisfy your sweet cravings without interfering with your recovery.

I've seen athletes put in the work in the gym, only to be left craving something sweet afterwards. These high-protein desserts are designed to give your body the nutrients it needs to repair and recover.

Let's dive in.

### **Protein-Infused Custard**

Custard is a classic comfort dessert that can be effortlessly upgraded into a nourishing, protein-rich treat.

**How to make it:** Start by cooking together 1 cup (240 ml) of milk, 2 egg yolks, 1 tablespoon (15 ml) of a natural sweetener like honey, and 1 tablespoon (8 g) of cornstarch to thicken it. Once the custard is ready, stir in 1 scoop (25 g) of your preferred protein powder. Top with a fresh fruit salad (75 g) to enhance the flavour and nutritional value.

**Why it works:** The protein helps repair muscle fibres and supports recovery, while the fruit adds antioxidants and fibre.

### **Protein Ice Cream (Whey or Plant-Based)**

When you've been working hard in the gym, a cold, creamy dessert can feel like the ultimate reward. Traditional ice cream might satisfy your cravings, but it often lacks the protein needed for recovery. This protein ice cream recipe is a great alternative.

**How to make it:** Mix your choice of protein powder (25 g) with 240 ml of milk (dairy or non-dairy) and add 1

tablespoon (15 ml) of a natural sweetener like maple syrup. You can add flavourings like 1 tablespoon (10 g) of cocoa powder or a handful of berries for extra flavour. Freeze for 2–3 hours, and you'll have a creamy, protein-packed dessert.

**Why it works:** The protein aids muscle recovery, and the milk provides additional nutrients like calcium.

### **Kulfi with Plant-Based Protein**

Kulfi is a rich, creamy Indian frozen dessert that's often enjoyed during festivals. By adding plant-based protein, you can make this dessert more beneficial for recovery while still enjoying its delicious flavour.

**How to make it:** Blend 1 cup (240 ml) of milk (or plant-based milk like almond or soya milk), 2 tablespoons (30 ml) of cream, 1 tablespoon (15 ml) of a natural sweetener like stevia, and 1 scoop (20–25 g) of your chosen protein powder. Add 2 tablespoons (30 g) of chopped pistachios or almonds for healthy fats and texture. Pour the mixture into moulds and freeze for 3–4 hours.

**Why it works:** It's a great balance of protein, fats, and carbohydrates to support your recovery and energy levels.

### **Greek Yoghurt Protein Bowl**

When time is tight, a Greek yoghurt protein bowl is an easy,